Current Affairs — UPPCS Prelims Analysis (2018–2025)

> **Sources:** Civils Campus CA Analysis PDF + YouTube strategy transcript (Aug 2026), reconciled against repo `pyq/2018`–`pyq/2025`.
> **Working load for prep: ~245–255 functional CA questions** (~26–39/year) — not the narrow Subject tag alone. **Next step:** build monthly topic sheets under Monthly Topics.

Decision

Current Affairs is a **mark bank + leveler**, not a side magazine.

What the data says	Revision decision
~30 functional CA questions most years	Treat CA like a full subject, not "last week reading".
History static often yields **~20–25**; one good CA magazine + revision can target **~20–27** correct	ROI is higher than thick static books if you read with key facts.
Freshers and repeaters start equal on CA	Freshers should not postpone CA for "static first".
7 topics ≈ 70% of functional CA	Build monthly notes only on the heat map first.

> **Target for 90% CA accuracy**

Do not read "everything in the magazine". Read every item through the **fact checklist** below. If a news item has no fact (publisher / venue / first / false second sentence / beneficiary number), skip or park it.

Repo PYQ reconciliation (important)

Civils Campus and this repo **do not use the same CA tag**. Use **functional CA** for study planning.

Count method	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	Total
Civils Campus CA set	28	26	28	26	31	32	33	31	**245**
Repo `Subject: Current Affairs` only	20	20	34	26	21	18	**9**	**13**	**161**
Repo strict CA+IR+Defence+Intl Days+Gov Schemes	20	20	34	26	21	19	21	17	**178**
Repo functional heuristic (schemes/space/awards/indices leakage)	~23	~26	~38	~33	~30	~39	~37	~29	**~255**

What this means:

1. **Do not plan from `Subject: Current Affairs` alone** — especially 2024–25, where many CA stems were retagged as **International Relations**, **Defence**, **Science and Technology**, or **Economy**.
2. Civils Campus **~30/year** still matches the paper if you count those hybrids. Repo functional totals land in the same band.
3. Early papers still hide CA inside broad **General Studies** tags (2018–2020).
4. Topic shares in the heat map below stay on the **Civils Campus classification** (clean 16-bucket split). Repo confirms the same trends: awards surge 2025, sports silent 2023–25, indices often under Economy/Environment, UP soft as a Subject but real as facts.

> **2024–25 tagging trap**

Opening only "Current Affairs" questions in `pyq/2024` or `pyq/2025` under-trains you. Also drill **IR + Defence + scheme/economy chronology + space/missile CA + awards**.

Year Weight (Civils Campus functional CA)

Year	Functional CA Qs	Repo notes
2018	28	Repo Subject CA = 20; rest in GS / hybrids
2019	26	Subject CA = 20
2020	28	Subject CA spike **34** (schemes-heavy paper)
2021	26	Subject CA = 26
2022	31	Subject CA = 21; science/economy hybrids rise
2023	32	Subject CA = 18; international heavy in Civils split
2024	**33**	Subject CA only **9** — IR 7 + Defence 4 + scheme/space leakage
2025	31	Subject CA **13**; **6 award stems**; UP Ramsar / ODOP / SDG

Planning rule: Budget **~30 marks** from functional CA every year. Format has shifted from one-liners toward **multi-statement / Match / NOT-matched**, especially 2024–25.

Topic Heat Map (8-year, Civils Campus buckets)

Rank	Topic	Total	Share	Trend 2022–25 vs 2018–21	Repo check
1	International (summits, elections, bilateral, UN)	53	**22%**	**Up** (18% → 25%)	Confirmed; 2024–25 often tagged IR
2	Government schemes / policies	31	**13%**	Slight down (spike was 2020)	Confirmed; many under Economy in 2024–25
3	Science / Space / Defence	20	**8%**	**Doubled** (5% → 11%)	Confirmed (RudraM, BrahMos, LUPEX, PraVaHa, Iron Dome, exercises)
4	Awards	20	**8%**	Up; **2025 surge**	Repo: **6 award Qs in 2025** alone
5	Environment / disasters / days	19	**8%**	Up	Days/themes + Operation Olivia / Ramsar hybrids
6	National events / institutions / infrastructure	18	**7%**	Stable	Pamban, FLY91, BHARATPOL, portals
7	Indices / rankings	17	**7%**	Down as solo topic	Repo: ranks sit under Economy / HDI / SDG / UP
8	First / records	12	**5%**	Fell after 2020 peak	Still high alert when “first” appears
9	Sports	11	**4%**	**Zero in 2023–25**	Repo confirms **no sports CA tags 2023–25**
10	Economy / budget / trade	10	**4%**	Up	FDI, Economic Survey, scheme chronology
11	Personalities / appointments	9	**4%**	Stable	Match List heads of state / personalities
12	Books / art & culture CA	8	**3%**	2023 spike	Booker / Jnanpith / Sahitya still live
13	Reports / statistics	7	**3%**	Stable	Groundwater report, population, ILO-type
14	Health / vaccine	5	**2%**	Fell post-COVID	Still appears as vaccine / declaration stems
15	Uttar Pradesh (core tagged)	3	**1%**	Soft in Civils row	**Under-count** — see UP section
16	Judiciary / constitution / governance CA	2	**1%**	Rare but high when news is hot	Adi Karmayogi / governance CA still appears

Backbone (memorise this)

- **International + Schemes + Science–Defence = ~104 / 245 (~43%).**
- Add **Awards + Environment + National + Indices ≈ another ~74**.
- Those **seven buckets ≈ 70%** of CA. Monthly notes should open with these seven.

> **UP is not 1%**

Civils Campus "UP Core Focus = 3" is too thin. In repo PYQs, UP CA facts also appear as Environment (Ramsar), Economy (ODOP), Uttar Pradesh Subject, SDG progress, infrastructure, and older Purvanchal / Kushinagar / aspirational-district stems. Keep a **dedicated UP CA sheet** at S-priority.

Format Shift (what traps look like)

Era	Paper feel	How they wrong-foot you
2018–21	Mixed one-liners + some statements	Wrong city, wrong year, wrong publisher
2022–25	**Statement machine** (esp. 2024–25)	One of two statements is deliberately false
First / Records	Stable	First sentence true; **second sentence** (city / range / payload) false
Match List	Rising	Head of state ↔ country; Day ↔ date; Book ↔ author; Scheme ↔ year

** logic to plant in every monthly note:** "Which fact would examiner flip to make Statement 2 false?"

How to Read Each Dimension (fact checklist)

Use this when scanning any monthly magazine. If you cannot fill the facts, the item is low-yield for UPPCS.

1. Indices / rankings (~1–4/year historically)

Fact	Ask
Publisher	Who releases it?
Parameters	What is counted / excluded?
Top 3	Global or Indian top ranks
India's rank	Exact or band
Findings	One headline finding for India / region
State angle	Top state / UP category (Performer, Aspirant, etc.)

Treat **indices and reports as one family**. Example pattern: World Population Report → **UNFPA**; TTCI → **WEF**.

2. Reports / statistics

Fact	Ask
Agency	Who published?
One number	%, rank, TFR, share
Static mix	Replacement-level TFR 2.1 type traps

3. First / largest / records

Any "first woman / first hydrogen / first e-Lok Adalat / 100% solar UT" is auto-important.

Fact	Ask
What is first?	Title of the record
Who / where / which country?	The identity line
Second fact	City, material, year — this is the usual false statement

Classic facts from PYQs: Diu 100% solar UT; UAE Hope mission; Motihari–Amlekhganj pipeline; first female WTO DG (Nigeria); Janet Yellen (US Treasury).

4. International — largest regular block (~22%)

Four repeating stems:

1. **Summits:** host country/city + edition + India representation (PM / President / EAM) + outcome / pact (binding or not).
2. **Foreign elections / leaders:** new PM/President; Indian-origin mayor/leader is high alert.
3. **Bilateral with neighbours (Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh) + extended neighbourhood:** joint projects, pipelines, buses, hydro, ports, FTAs, UPI deals.
4. **Org HQ / heads:** ISA Gurugram; IMF MD; WTO DG; "NOT a member" traps (GCC, BIMSTEC, G7 invitees).

FTA extra facts: partners, duty-free share, exception list, timeline.

5. National events / institutions / infrastructure

Pattern	What they ask
Location	Institute, tunnel, bridge, museum, fair, secretariat
Statements	Correct / incorrect on theme, agency, feature
Match	Day ↔ event; institute ↔ place
Who / when	Signatory, developer, executing agency
State CA	New policy, election, appointment, resource find

6. Awards (~8%; hot in 2025)

Fact	Ask
Winner	Name
Field / work	Why awarded
Edition / venue	nth edition, host city
Giver	Body / country
India angle	Indian winner or PM civilian honour abroad

Cover Nobel, Booker, Oscar, Pulitzer, Ramon Magsaysay, plus national: Padma, Khel Ratna, Arjuna, Vigyan Ratna, Sahitya Akademi, Jnanpith. UN / UNESCO awards are priority.

7. Sports (thin lately)

Host, edition, motto, brand ambassador, India's medals / rank, winner vs runner-up, **incorrect medal-colour pairs**. Olympics / Asian Games / World Cups still matter when they fall in the window; 2023–25 tagged sports were quiet.

8. Government schemes (~13%)

Fact	Ask
Start year / end year / tenure	Period traps (NIP 2020–25 vs 2020–30)
Ministry / Nodal body	NITI vs ministry
Beneficiaries + exclusions	Who is in / out
Target number / DBT amount	₹6000, 1 crore households, etc.
Allocation	Budget line if announced
Rename	Mid-Day Meal → PM POSHAN type

Favourite formats: find incorrect statement; only Statement 1 correct; Match scheme ↔ year; A/R on period or objective.

9. Uttar Pradesh CA

Major initiative in the last ~12 months; unique infrastructure; UP rank in national indices; new Ramsar; defence/hydrogen/fertiliser plant; FDI rank; crop/milk leadership; ODOP; SDG progress.

Known PYQ cluster: Purvanchal Expressway (route trap), Noida Charkha, UP SDG = Performer, HRIDAY = Varanasi + Mathura, Kushinagar international airport, Ramsar sites, aspirational districts count, **2025:** UP Ramsar, ODOP, UP SDG Progress Report.

Repo rule: search Environment + Economy + Subject `Uttar Pradesh` + Current Affairs — not UP Subject alone.

10. Science / Space / Defence (rising)

Space	Defence
Mission date, target body, agency, rocket, vehicle	Missile name, range, partner country
Arrival / outcome	Indigenous platform (UAV, bomber, sub, helo)
Private space startup novelty	Exercise name (bilateral/multilateral), participants
ISRO PSLV/GSLV flights	Procurement from which country; Project 75/75I style

11. Health

Disease-free declarations; new vaccines; rare-disease outbreaks (where + cause); WHO declarations; Ayurveda / traditional medicine centres (e.g. Jamnagar).

12. Books / personalities

~1 book–author stem most years; award-winning books first. Appointments: CDS, SEBI, Speakers, Governors, Assembly Speakers (Match List). Indian-origin abroad = instant attention.

13. Economy / budget / trade

Union Budget + Economic Survey + UP Budget/Survey; GDP/GNP snapshots; MSP; core industries; WPI/CPI (base year, agency, frequency); FDI source/sector/state; NSO / RBI reports (LFPR, FSR); FTA/trade diversification.

14. Environment / days

Summit / declaration / award; Mission LiFE; Project Cheetah; Operation Olivia; Net-Zero ≠ zero emissions; Day ↔ theme match; India GHG rank; species–state pairs.

15. Judiciary / constitution (rare CA)

Hot SC judgments, recent amendments, major legislation name + date + object — only when the news is loud.

Comparison Block: 2018–21 vs 2022–25

Aspect	2018–21	2022–25	Inference for 2026 prep
International	18%	**25%**	Neighbours + summits + "not a member"
Schemes	14% (30% in 2020)	11%	Fewer Qs, but false statements remain
Indices alone	10%	4%	Ranks now inside budget / remittances / state spend
Science–Defence	5%	**11%**	Missiles, UAVs, exercises, ISRO dates
Sports	6%	3% (only 2022)	Space taken by awards / science
Economy	3%	6%	Budget / trade rising
Format	Mixed MCQs	Statement machine	Practise two-statement traps

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Sources Strategy (from transcript + practical merge)

Approach	Sources	When to use
Yearly consolidation	Vision IAS PT 365 / Drishti; Ghatna Chakra / Ghatna Saar	If starting late (≤3 months to prelims), pick **one** yearly + revise hard
Monthly	Chronicle / Pratiyogita Darpan / Drishti monthly	Best for continuous coverage + monthly topic updates
Gap-fill	Multi-source short notes (Civils Campus CA PDF style)	After primary source — catches the **~10–15%** that one magazine misses

Practical rule for this site: pick **one primary monthly**, update the topic files here every month, then once before prelims do a yearly consolidation pass using the same fact checklists.

Overlap between Vision and Ghatna-type yearlies is roughly **85–90%**. The remaining **10%** is where wrong options often hide — hence a second short pass.

Must-Score Reading Order (weekly)

1. **International** (summits this month + neighbour bilateral + org heads).
2. **Schemes** (new / renamed / budgeted) with tenure + beneficiary facts.
3. **Science–Space–Defence** (ISRO + missile/exercise + indigenous kit).
4. **Awards + Environment/Days + National infra**.
5. **Indices/Reports** (publisher + India/UP rank).
6. **Firsts**, Economy/Budget, Books, Appointments, Health.
7. **UP CA** sheet — every major state news with place / rank / scheme fact.

Mock Audit (after every CA mock)

- Missed because **publisher / venue / edition** was wrong?
- Fell for **true Statement 1 + false Statement 2**?
- Confused **member vs non-member** of a grouping?
- Skipped a **first / Indian-origin / PM honour** item?
- Scheme error on **year, ministry, or beneficiary number**?
- UP item lost on **route / city / Ramsar / rank category**?

If the same audit line repeats twice, that dimension's monthly file is incomplete.

What This Folder Will Become

File	Role
This analysis	Static playbook — update only when a new prelims year is tagged
Monthly Topics	Living sheets — you update every month with new news under fixed facts
Later: Complete CA PYQ Bank	Full 2018–2025 stems with logic + Show answer (after your PYQ merge command)

> **Pipeline**

Done: PDF + transcript analysis, then **repo PYQ reconciliation** (counts, 2024–25 retags, awards/sports/UP checks). **Fixed in repo:** `pyq/2023` placeholder duplicates for Q54–60 removed (file is clean 150). **Next:** create monthly topic files and a Complete CA PYQ Bank with logic. **Goal:** monthly consolidation aiming at **~90% CA accuracy**.